FREE CHECKLIST · ABOUT 2 HOURS

AI Evals for Designers: Quick Checklist

Five steps to find where your AI product goes wrong, using 20 real answers and a spreadsheet. About two hours, no code.

STEP 1

Collect 20 real answers

Pull 20 real conversations or outputs from your product. Include the awkward ones: requests it cannot handle, missing information, things it should refuse.

About 20 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Support bot** — Real tickets, including refund requests and an angry customer
- **Writing assistant** — Drafts from very short prompts and off-brand requests
- **Search or summary** — Questions with no good answer in the sources

STEP 2

Mark each one pass or fail

Ask one question: would I be happy if a real user got this? When it fails, write one plain line on the first thing wrong. No scores and no categories yet.

About 40 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Support bot** — Fail: promises a refund it cannot issue
- **Writing assistant** — Fail: tone far too casual for a legal email
- **Search or summary** — Fail: summary leaves out the main caveat

STEP 3

Group the notes and count

Sort the notes into piles the way you would affinity-map research. Count each pile. The biggest pile is your first problem.

About 20 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Support bot** — Claims actions it cannot take
- **Writing assistant** — Ignores the requested tone
- **Search or summary** — Drops important caveats

STEP 4

Turn the biggest pile into one rule

Write it as a yes or no question that anyone on the team could apply to an answer and get the same verdict.

About 10 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Support bot** — Does it only promise actions the product can actually take?
- **Writing assistant** — Does the draft match the tone the user asked for?
- **Search or summary** — Does the summary keep every caveat from the source?

STEP 5

Fix, then re-check the same 20 plus 5 new ones

Change one thing, rerun the same answers and apply the same rule. Add a few the fix never saw, so you know it works beyond the ones you tuned it on.

About 30 min for 20 answers

FOR EXAMPLE

- **Any product** — Count how many answers break the rule, before and after
- **Any product** — Read the new ones too: a fix can quietly break something else

Review sheet

One row per answer. Mark pass or fail, write the first thing wrong in one line, then group the notes once all 20 are done.

#	Input (what the user asked or did)	Output (what the AI said)	Pass / Fail	First thing wrong (one line)	Group
1					
2					
3					
4					
5					
6					
7					
8					
9					
10					
11					
12					
13					
14					
15					
16					
17					
18					
19					
20					